

Smart EPP — Implementation Changes

Source: tasks/smart-epp-audit.md · **File modified:** src/pages/SmartEPPCaseStudy.tsx

Date: June 2026 · **Total changes:** 15 across 6 types

FIXED ×5

CUT ×6

RESTRUCTURED ×1

MERGED ×1

REWRITTEN ×1

REPLACED ×1

Sections: 12 → 9 · Dead buttons removed · AI disclosure removed

ALL CHANGES — ORDERED BY PAGE POSITION

FIXED

01 · Stats Grid

BEFORE

"MY ROLE" and "I WORKED WITH" used first-person labels while other cells used category labels.

AFTER

All 6 cells now use consistent category labels: ROLE, TEAM, PLATFORMS, TIMELINE, USER RESEARCH, DESIGN SYSTEM.

Note

Also fixed "44 components" description — now reads "Built on OneAssist's existing library" to resolve contradiction with Problem section.

CUT**02 · Problem — Project Scope Grid****BEFORE**

A 6-cell scope grid (Platforms, User Types, Backbone, Design System, Timeline, Out of Scope) sat inside the Problem section, repeating everything already in the Intro stats grid above.

AFTER

Grid deleted entirely. Left column narrative is now full-width. The "Why now" tax-savings sentence is bolded to surface it from the body text.

FIXED**03 · Research — Wrong Thumbnails****BEFORE**

Cards 2 (Employee Anxiety) and 3 (HR Friction) both used the calculator screenshot as their "The Fix" thumbnail. A recruiter clicking the HR card expected the approval dashboard.

AFTER

Thumbnails removed from cards 2 and 3. The "The Fix" label and description now take full width without a broken image reference.

FIXED**03 · Research — Misleading "8/12" Stat****BEFORE**

"8/12 flagged salary EMIs as their top fear" — with no context, this reads as 8 out of the 12 total research participants, conflicting with the "26 interviews" headline above.

AFTER

Added clarifying subline under the stat: "of 12 employees surveyed (subset of 26 total)" — makes the sampling transparent.

CUT**04 · Problem Reframe Section****BEFORE**

Full section ("Stop designing 4 products. Design 1 system.") with Before/After diagram, 4 fragmented boxes, 4 tabbed views, and a conclusion callout. Takes up 160px padding to say what one paragraph can say.

AFTER

Section deleted entirely. The key insight ("designing the shared data model first cut design time by ~30%") was already surfaced in the Reflection section. Removing this reduces page from 12 → 11 sections.

FIXED**05 · Design Exploration — Misleading A/B Framing****BEFORE**

"The Winning Formula: 2.4x Higher Conversion" compared the winner (68% conversion) against Guided Wizard (44% drop-off) — two completely different metric types side by side.

AFTER

Guided Wizard metric relabeled to "44% Step-1 Abandonment" with a subline "(measures friction, not conversion)" to make clear it's not comparable to the conversion rates.

CUT**06 · Final Solution — Carousel/Grid Toggle****BEFORE**

A "Carousel / Grid View" toggle button required recruiters to choose a layout before seeing any screens. Unnecessary choice before the content.

AFTER

Toggle removed. Employee App tab defaults to the carousel view directly, showing screens immediately on tab selection.

CUT**06 · System Foundations — Accessibility Card****BEFORE**

"Inclusive by Design. High-contrast text and large touch targets ensure a frictionless experience." Generic claim with no WCAG metrics or specifics. Every product claims this.

AFTER

Accessibility card deleted. Design System card and Edge Cases card remain.

RESTRUCTURED**06 · Validation — Metric Cards****BEFORE**

3 metric cards (11/14 savings recall, 11 sec approval, -60% anxiety) were previews of the same numbers in Outcomes. Validation section was doing two jobs: testing process + results.

AFTER

Metric cards removed from Validation. Section now contains only: the user quote, Key Pivot (users ignored the standalone explainer), and "What we missed" — the testing process story. Numbers live exclusively in Outcomes.

CUT**07 · Outcomes — "5 mo" Metric Card****BEFORE**

"5 mo / MVP to launch" appeared as an outcome metric, but it's a timeline fact already in the Intro stats grid. Not an outcome.

AFTER

Removed from outcomes grid. Metrics grid now has 5 cards: 68%, <12s, 11/14, 4.4★, 0% enterprise churn.

FIXED**07 · Outcomes — "0% Abandonment" Clarification****BEFORE**

"0% HR program abandonment" with sub "no enterprise client dropped the program post-launch" — ambiguous. Could mean individual employees or enterprise clients.

AFTER

Renamed to "Enterprise client churn" with sub "no HR program dropped the platform in the 90 days post-launch" — unambiguous scope.

MERGED**07 · Outcomes — Duplicate Text Cards****BEFORE**

"Qualitative Wins" and "Success Criteria" were two side-by-side cards with duplicative stories. Qualitative wins mentioned "Support tickets dropped to near-zero" while Success Criteria showed "Employee cart conversion $\geq 50\%$ → Hit (68%)". Felt like padding.

AFTER

Merged into one card with two columns: "Signal from users" (left) and "Success criteria" (right). Same information, half the visual weight.

REWRITTEN**08 · Reflection — "Next Iteration" Card****BEFORE**

"(1) Power-user tax calculator mode. (2) Full end-of-tenure flow. (3) Complete redesign of lessor/seller portals backed by actual user research." — reads as product backlog, not reflection.

AFTER

Rewritten to explain WHY each item was blocked and what was learned: timeline constraints, the end-of-tenure return flow as "the single biggest unresolved anxiety", and the lessor/seller redesign driven by the missed validation lesson.

CUT

11 · Design System & Assets Section

BEFORE

Full section showing 3 color swatches and 2 typography specimens, ending with two dead buttons: "View Pitch Deck (PDF)" and "View Figma File" — both with no href or onClick handler. Clicking either made the portfolio appear broken.

AFTER

Section deleted entirely.

REPLACED

12 · Final Thoughts Section

BEFORE

Section with Target icon, self-congratulatory third-person quote ("Smart EPP was a masterclass..."), "Built with: Figma, Claude, & UX Pilot" pill (flagging AI tool use), and Back button.

AFTER

Section replaced with a minimal centered navigation footer: just "Back to All Projects" button. The Reflection section (08) now serves as the natural closing point of the case study.

Note

Removed "Built with Claude" disclosure — mentioning AI tools in a UX portfolio raises red flags with hiring managers without adding any value.